



Art – Intermediate 1

OPTIMA ACADEMY ONLINE · FAMILY COURSE OVERVIEW · GRADE 3 · INTERMEDIATE SERIES · FULL YEAR

80 min per week · 2 lessons weekly

About this overview. This document is an example of how the course might be taught. This page is drawn from the Florida course description rather than a built Optima course, so the specific artworks studied, projects, and activities will be set by the teacher and may vary between the live school and On-Demand. Each teacher also leans into their own strengths and passions; the structure, expectations, and time commitment below are representative of the course as designed.

Intermediate 1 opens the upper-elementary art series. Scholars work in both two and three dimensions across art and digital media, applying materials correctly and safely to express their own interests. The real shift this year is in thinking: scholars begin genuine art criticism — reflecting on and interpreting works of art with observation skills and prior knowledge, critiquing their own and others' work using the elements of art and principles of design, and using constructive criticism to make their next piece better. Art exemplars from different times and cultures feed their own ideas.

THE YEAR AT A GLANCE

1 Making Art (all year)

Tools and media handled to achieve intended results in 2-D and 3-D work; craftsmanship through repeated practice; safe studio habits.

3 Art Criticism (all year)

Reflecting on and interpreting works of art; critiquing one's own and others' work; using constructive criticism to improve.

5 Art in My World (all year)

Artists and designers in the community, collaboration, copyright awareness, and finishing work on time — perseverance in practice.

2 The Artist's Eye (all year)

Arranging the elements of art with the principles of design on purpose; creative and innovative ideas in personal work.

4 Art Across Cultures and Time (all year)

Comparing artworks across time and culture, drawing ideas from exemplars, and respecting the ideas cultures express in art.

A TYPICAL WEEK

- Two art lessons each week.
- Lessons pair looking and making: scholars study real artworks, then apply what they noticed in their own work.
- Regular critique: scholars talk about their own and classmates' work using real art vocabulary.
- Hands-on throughout — this course is built around real art materials, used safely and responsibly.

TIME COMMITMENT

80 minutes / week

two lessons a week, about 40 minutes each

- Most weeks pair two lessons of looking, learning, making, and critique.
- Some projects span more than one lesson.

WHAT SCHOLARS NEED

- Art supplies: pencils, crayons or markers, paper, scissors, and glue, plus materials as assigned.
- A computer with reliable internet and access to Canvas.
- A space where making — and a little mess — is okay.

On-Demand (asynchronous). Scholars move through the course at their own pace, with due dates to keep the year on track. An Optima teacher is available throughout for support, feedback, and grading.

Live school. Live-school scholars take this same course on Optima's VR campus with a teacher and classmates, meeting twice a week as a specials class on the school's weekly schedule.